[8] Then the nations set out against him from the provinces on every side. They spread their net over him; he was trapped in their pit. [9] With hooks they caged him and brought him to the king of Babylon. They brought him into captivity so that his roar was heard no longer on the mountains of Israel. [10] Your mother was like a vine in your vineyard, planted by the water; it was fruitful and full of branches because of the abundant waters. [11] It had strong branches, fit for a ruler's scepter. It towered high above the thick branches, conspicuous for its height and for its dense foliage. [12] But it was uprooted in fury, cast down to the ground, and the east wind dried up its fruit. Its strong branches were stripped off and they withered; the fire consumed them. [13] Now it is planted in the wilderness, in a dry and thirsty land. [14] "Fire has gone out from its main branch and devoured its fruit; on it no strong branch remains fit for a ruler's scepter.' This is a lament and shall be used as a lament."

20 In the seventh year, on the tenth day of the fifth month, some of the elders of Israel came to inquire of the LORD, and they sat down before me. [2] Then the word of the LORD came to me, saying, [3] "Son of man, speak to the elders of Israel and tell them that this is what the Lord GOD says: Have you come to inquire of Me? As surely as I live, I will not be consulted by you, declares the Lord GOD." [4] Will you judge them, will you judge them, son of man? Confront them with the abominations of their fathers [5] and tell them that this is what the Lord GOD says: On the day I chose Israel, I swore an oath to the descendants of the house of Jacob and made Myself known to them in the land of Egypt. With an uplifted hand I said to them, 'I am the LORD your God.' [6] On that day I swore to bring them out of the land of Egypt into a land that I had searched out for them, a land flowing with milk and honey, the glory of all lands. [7] And I said to them: 'Each of you must throw away the abominations before his eyes, and you must not defile yourselves with the idols of Egypt. I am the LORD your God.' [8] But they rebelled against Me and refused to listen. None of them cast away the abominations before their eyes, and they did not forsake the idols of Egypt. So I resolved to pour out My wrath upon them and vent My anger against them in the land of Egypt. [9] But I acted for the sake of My name, that it should not be profaned in the eyes of the nations among whom they were living, in whose sight I had revealed Myself to Israel by bringing them out of the land of Egypt. [10] So I brought them out of the land of Egypt and led them into the wilderness. [11] And I gave them My statutes and made known to them My ordinances—for the man who does these things will live by them. [12] I also gave them My Sabbaths as a sign between us, so that they would know that I am the LORD who sanctifies them. [13] Yet the house of Israel rebelled against Me in the wilderness. They did not follow My statutes and they rejected My ordinances—though the man who does these things will live by them—and they utterly profaned My Sabbaths. Then I resolved to pour out My wrath upon them and put an end to them in the wilderness. [14] But I acted for the sake of My name, so that it would not be profaned in the eyes of the nations in whose sight I had brought them out. [15] Moreover, with an uplifted hand I swore to them in the wilderness that I would not bring them into the land that I had given them—a land flowing with milk and honey, the glory of all lands—

[16] because they kept rejecting My ordinances, refusing to walk in My statutes, and profaning My Sabbaths; for their hearts continually went after their idols. [17] Yet I looked on them with pity and did not destroy them or bring them to an end in the wilderness. [18] In the wilderness I said to their children: 'Do not walk in the statutes of your fathers or keep their ordinances or defile yourselves with their idols.' [19] I am the LORD your God; walk in My statutes, keep My ordinances, and practice them. [20] Keep My Sabbaths holy, that they may be a sign between us, so that you may know that I am the LORD your God.'

[21] But the children rebelled against Me. They did not walk in My statutes or carefully observe My ordinances—though the man who does these things will live by them—and they profaned My Sabbaths. So I resolved to pour out My wrath upon them and vent My anger against them in the wilderness. [22] But I withheld My hand and acted for the sake of My name, so that it would not be profaned in the eyes of the nations in whose sight I had brought them out. [23] However, with an uplifted hand I swore to them in the wilderness that I would scatter them among the nations and disperse them throughout the lands. [24] For they did not practice My ordinances, but they rejected My statutes and profaned My Sabbaths, fixing their eyes on the idols of their fathers. [25] I also gave them over to statutes that were not good and ordinances by which they could not live. [26] And I pronounced them unclean through their gifts—the sacrifice of every firstborn in the fire—so that I might devastate them, in order that they would know that I am the LORD. [27] Therefore, son of man, speak to the house of Israel, and tell them that this is what the Lord GOD says: In this way also your fathers blasphemed Me by their unfaithfulness against Me. [28] When I brought them into the land that I swore to give them and they saw any high hill or leafy tree, there they offered their sacrifices, presented offerings that provoked Me, sent up their fragrant incense, and poured out their drink offerings. [29] So I asked them: 'What is this high place to which you go?' (And to this day it is called Bamah.) [30] Therefore tell the house of Israel that this is what the Lord GOD says: Will you defile yourselves the way your fathers did, prostituting yourselves with their abominations? [31] When you offer your gifts, sacrificing your sons in the fire, you continue to defile yourselves with all your idols to this day. So should I be consulted by you, O house of Israel? As surely as I live, declares the Lord GOD, I will not be consulted by you!

[32] When you say, 'Let us be like the nations, like the peoples of the lands, serving wood and stone,' what you have in mind will never come to pass. [33] As surely as I live, declares the Lord GOD, with a strong hand, an outstretched arm, and outpoured wrath I will rule over you. [34] With a strong hand, an outstretched arm, and outpoured wrath I will bring you out from the peoples and gather you from the lands to which you have been scattered. [35] And I will bring you into the wilderness of the nations, where I will enter into judgment with you face to face. [36] Just as I entered into judgment with your fathers in the wilderness of the land of Egypt, so I will enter into judgment with you, declares the Lord GOD. [37] I will make you pass under the rod and will bring you into the bond of the covenant. [38] And I will purge you of those who rebel and transgress against Me. I will bring them out of the land in which they dwell, but they will not enter the land of Israel. Then you will know that I am the LORD. [39] And as for you, O house of Israel, this is what the Lord GOD says: Go and serve your idols, every one of you. But afterward, you will surely listen to Me, and you will no longer defile My holy name with your gifts and idols. [40] For on My holy mountain, the high mountain of Israel, declares the Lord GOD, there the whole house of Israel, all of them, will serve Me in the land. There I will accept them and will require your offerings and choice gifts, along with all your holy sacrifices. [41] When I bring you from the peoples and gather you from the lands to which you have been scattered, I will accept you as a pleasing aroma. And I will show My holiness through you in the sight of the nations. [42] Then you will know that I am the LORD, when I bring you into the land of Israel, the land that I swore to give your fathers. [43] There you will remember your ways and all the deeds with which you have defiled yourselves, and you will loathe yourselves for all the evils you have done. [44] "Then you will know, O house of Israel, that I am the LORD, when I have dealt with you for the sake of My name and not according to your wicked ways and corrupt acts, declares the Lord GOD." [45] Now the word of the LORD came to me, saying, [46] "Son of man, set your face toward the south, preach against it, and prophesy against the forest of the Negev." [47] Say to the forest of the Negev: Hear the word of the LORD! This is what the Lord GOD says: I am about to ignite in you a fire, and it will devour all your trees, both green and dry. The blazing flame will not be quenched, and by it every face from south to north will be scorched. [48] "Then all people will see that I, the LORD, have kindled it; it will not be quenched." [49] Then I said, "Ah, Lord GOD, they are saying of me, 'Is he not just telling parables?'"

21 And the word of the LORD came to me, saying, [2] "Son of man, set your face against Jerusalem and preach against the sanctuaries. Prophesy against the land of Israel" [3] and tell her that this is what the LORD says: 'I am against you, and I will draw My sword from its sheath and cut off from you both the righteous and the wicked.' [4] Because I will cut off both the righteous and the wicked, My sword will be unsheathed against everyone from south to north. [5] Then all flesh will know that I, the LORD, have taken My sword from its sheath, not to return it again.' [6] But you, son of man, groan! Groan before their eyes with a broken heart and bitter grief. [7] "And when they ask, 'Why are you groaning?' you are to say, 'Because of the news that is coming. Every heart will melt, and every hand will go limp. Every spirit will faint, and every knee will turn to water.' Yes, it is coming and it will surely happen, declares the Lord GOD." [8] Again the word of the LORD came to me, saying, [9] "Son of man, prophesy and tell them that this is what the Lord says: 'A sword, a sword, sharpened and polished—'"

[10] it is sharpened for the slaughter, polished to flash like lightning! Should we rejoice in the scepter of My son? The sword despises every such stick. [11] The sword is appointed to be polished, to be grasped in the hand. It is sharpened and polished, to be placed in the hand of the slayer. [12] Cry out and wail, O son of man, for the sword is wielded against My people; it is against all the princes of Israel! They are tossed to the sword with My people; therefore strike your thigh. [13] Surely testing will come! And what if even the scepter, which the sword despises, does not continue?' declares the Lord GOD.

[14] 'So then, son of man, prophesy and strike your hands together. Let the sword strike two times, even three. It is a sword that slays, a sword of great slaughter closing in on every side!' [15] So that their hearts may melt and many may stumble, I have appointed at all their gates a sword for slaughter. Yes, it is ready to flash like lightning; it is drawn for slaughter. [16] Slash to the right; set your blade to the left — wherever your blade is directed. [17] "I too will strike My hands together, and I will satisfy My wrath.' I, the LORD, have spoken." [18] Then the word of the LORD came to me, saying, [19] "Now you, son of man, mark out two roads for the sword of the king of Babylon to take, both starting from the same land. And make a signpost where the road branches off to each city." [20] Mark out one road for the sword to come against Rabbah of the Ammonites, and another against Judah into fortified Jerusalem.

[21] For the king of Babylon stands at the fork in the road, at the junction of the two roads, to seek an omen: He shakes the arrows, he consults the idols, he examines the liver. [22] In his right hand appears the portent for Jerusalem, where he is to set

up battering rams, to call for the slaughter, to lift a battle cry, to direct the battering rams against the gates, to build a ramp, and to erect a siege wall. [23] It will seem like a false omen to the eyes of those who have sworn allegiance to him, but it will draw attention to their guilt and take them captive. [24] Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: 'Because you have drawn attention to your guilt, exposing your transgressions, so that your sins are revealed in all your deeds—because you have come to remembrance—you shall be taken in hand.' [25] And you, O profane and wicked prince of Israel, the day has come for your final punishment.' [26] This is what the Lord GOD says: 'Remove the turban, and take off the crown. Things will not remain as they are: Exalt the lowly and bring low the exalted.' [27] A ruin, a ruin, I will make it a ruin! And it will not be restored until the arrival of Him to whom it belongs, to whom I have assigned the right of judgment.' [28] Now prophesy, son of man, and declare that this is what the Lord GOD says concerning the Ammonites and their contempt: 'A sword! A sword is drawn for slaughter, polished to consume, to flash like lightning—' [29] while they offer false visions for you and lying divinations about you— to be placed on the necks of the wicked who are slain, whose day has come, the time of their final punishment. [30] Return the sword to its sheath! In the place where you were created, in the land of your origin, I will judge you. [31] I will pour out My anger upon you; I will breathe the fire of My fury against you; I will hand you over to brutal men, skilled in destruction. [32] "You will be fuel for the fire. Your blood will stain your own land. You will not be remembered, for I, the LORD, have spoken.'"

22 Then the word of the LORD came to me, saying, [2] "As for you, son of man, will you judge her? Will you pass judgment on the city of bloodshed? Then confront her with all her abominations" [3] and tell her that this is what the Lord GOD says: 'O city who brings her own doom by shedding blood within her walls and making idols to defile herself,' [4] you are guilty of the blood you have shed, and you are defiled by the idols you have made. You have brought your days to a close and have come to the end of your years. Therefore I have made you a reproach to the nations and a mockery to all the lands. [5] Those near and far will mock you, O infamous city, full of turmoil. [6] See how every prince of Israel within you has used his power to shed blood. [7] Father and mother are treated with contempt. Within your walls the foreign resident is exploited, the fatherless and the widow are oppressed. [8] You have despised My holy things and profaned My Sabbaths. [9] Among you are slanderous men bent on bloodshed; within you are those who eat on the mountain shrines and commit acts of indecency.

[10] In you they have uncovered the nakedness of their fathers; in you they violate women during their menstrual impurity. [11] One man commits an abomination with his neighbor's wife; another wickedly defiles his daughter-in-law; and yet another violates his sister, his own father's daughter. [12] In you they take bribes to shed blood. You engage in usury, take excess interest, and extort your neighbors. But Me you have forgotten, declares the Lord GOD. [13] Now look, I strike My hands together against your unjust gain and against the blood you have shed in your midst.

[14] Will your courage endure or your hands be strong in the day I deal with you? I, the LORD, have spoken, and I will act. [15] I will disperse you among the nations and scatter you throughout the lands; I will purge your uncleanness. [16] "And when you have defiled yourself in the eyes of the nations, then you will know that I am the LORD.'" [17] Then the word of the LORD came to me, saying, [18] "Son of man, the house of Israel has become dross to Me. All of them are copper, tin, iron, and lead inside the furnace; they are but the dross of silver." [19] Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: 'Because all of you have become dross, behold, I will gather you into Jerusalem.'

[20] Just as one gathers silver, copper, iron, lead, and tin into the furnace to melt with a fiery blast, so I will gather you in My anger and wrath, leave you there, and melt you. [21] Yes, I will gather you together and blow on you with the fire of My wrath, and you will be melted within the city. [22] "As silver is melted in a furnace, so you will be melted within the city. Then you will know that I, the LORD, have poured out My wrath upon you.'" [23] And the word of the LORD came to me, saying, [24] "Son of man, say to her, 'In the day of indignation, you are a land that has not been cleansed, upon which no rain has fallen.'" [25] The conspiracy of the princes in her midst is like a roaring lion tearing its prey. They devour the people, seize the treasures and precious things, and multiply the widows within her. [26] Her priests do violence to My law and profane My holy things. They make no distinction between the holy and the common, and they fail to distinguish between the clean and the unclean. They disregard My Sabbaths, so that I am profaned among them. [27] Her officials within her are like wolves tearing their prey, shedding blood, and destroying lives for dishonest gain. [28] Her prophets whitewash these deeds by false visions and lying divinations, saying, 'This is what the Lord GOD says,' when the LORD has not spoken. [29] The people of the land have practiced extortion and committed robbery. They have oppressed the poor and needy and have exploited the foreign resident without justice. [30] I searched for a man among them to repair the wall and stand in the gap before Me on behalf of the land, so that I should not destroy it. But I found no one. [31] "So I have poured out My indignation upon them and consumed them with the fire of My fury. I have brought their ways down upon their own heads, declares the Lord GOD."

23 Again the word of the LORD came to me, saying, [2] "Son of man, there were two women, daughters of the same mother," [3] and they played in Egypt, prostituting themselves from their youth. Their breasts were fondled there, and their virgin bosoms caressed. [4] The older was named Oholah, and her sister was named Oholibah. They became Mine and gave birth to sons and daughters. As for their identities, Oholah is Samaria, and Oholibah is Jerusalem. [5] Oholah prostituted herself while she was still Mine. She lusted after her lovers, the Assyrians—warriors [6] clothed in blue, governors and commanders, all desirable young men, horsemen mounted on steeds. [7] She offered sexual favors to all the elite of Assyria. She defiled herself with all the idols of those for whom she lusted. [8] She did not give up the prostitution she began in Egypt, when men slept with her in her youth, caressed her virgin bosom, and poured out their lust upon her. [9] Therefore I delivered her into the hands of her lovers, the Assyrians for whom she lusted. [10] They exposed her nakedness, seized her sons and daughters, and put her to the sword. Thus she became a byword among women, and they executed judgment against her. [11] Her sister Oholibah saw this, yet in her lust and prostitution she was more depraved than her sister. [12] She too lusted after the Assyrians—governors and commanders, warriors dressed in splendor, horsemen riding on steeds, all desirable young men. [13] And I saw that she too had defiled herself; both of them had taken the same path. [14] But Oholibah carried her prostitution even further. She saw the men portrayed on the wall, images of the Chaldeans, engraved in vermilion, [15] wearing belts on their waists and flowing turbans on their heads; all of them looked like officers of the Babylonians in Chaldea, the land of their birth.

[16] At the sight of them, she lusted for them and sent messengers to them in Chaldea. [17] Then the Babylonians came to her, to the bed of love, and in their lust they defiled her. But after she had been defiled by them, she turned away in disgust. [18] When Oholibah openly prostituted herself and exposed her nakedness, I turned away from her in disgust, just as I had turned away from her sister. [19] Yet she multiplied her promiscuity, remembering the days of her youth, when she had prostituted herself in the land of Egypt [20] and lusted after their lovers, whose genitals were like those of donkeys and whose emission was like that of stallions.

[21] So you revisited the indecency of your youth, when the Egyptians caressed your bosom and pressed your young breasts. [22] Therefore, Oholibah, this is what the Lord GOD says: 'I will incite your lovers against you, those from whom you turned away in disgust. And I will bring them against you from every side—' [23] the Babylonians and all the Chaldeans, the men of Pekod, Shoa, and Koa, and all the Assyrians with them—all desirable young men, governors and commanders, officers and men of renown, mounted on horses. [24] They will come against you with a host of peoples, with weapons, chariots, and wagons. They will array themselves against you on every side with buckler and shield and helmet. I will delegate judgment to them, and they will punish you according to their own standards. [25] And I will set My jealous rage against you, and they will deal with you in fury. They will cut off your noses and ears, and your survivors will fall by the sword. They will seize your sons and daughters, and your remnant will be consumed by fire. [26] They will strip off your clothes and take your fine jewelry. [27] So I will put an end to your indecency and prostitution, which began in the land of Egypt, and you will not lift your eyes to them or remember Egypt anymore.' [28] For this is what the Lord GOD says: 'Surely I will deliver you into the hands of those you hate, from whom you turned away in disgust.' [29] They will treat you with hatred, take all for which you have worked, and leave you naked and bare, so that the shame of your prostitution will be exposed. Your indecency and promiscuity [30] have brought these things upon you, because you have prostituted yourself with the nations and defiled yourself with their idols. [31] Because you have followed the path of your sister, I will put her cup into your hand.'

[32] This is what the Lord GOD says: 'You will drink your sister's cup, a cup deep and wide. It will bring scorn and derision, for it holds so much.' [33] You will be filled with drunkenness and grief, with a cup of devastation and desolation, the cup of your sister Samaria. [34] You will drink it and drain it; you will dash it to pieces, and tear your breasts. For I have spoken,' declares the Lord GOD. [35] "Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: 'Because you have forgotten Me and have cast Me behind your back, you must bear the consequences of your indecency and prostitution.'" [36] Then the LORD said to me: "Son of man, will you pass judgment against Oholah and Oholibah? Then declare to them their abominations." [37] For they have committed adultery, and blood is on their hands. They have committed adultery with their idols. They have even sacrificed their children, whom they bore to Me, in the fire as food for their idols. [38] They have also done this to Me: On that very same day, they defiled My sanctuary and profaned My Sabbaths. [39] On the very day they slaughtered their children for their idols, they entered My sanctuary to profane it. Yes, they did this inside My house. [40] Furthermore, you sisters sent messengers for men who came from afar; and behold, when they arrived, you bathed for them, painted your eyes, and adorned yourself with jewelry. [41] You sat on a couch of luxury with a table spread before it, on which you had set My incense and My oil, [42] accompanied by the sound of a carefree crowd. Drunkards were brought in from the desert along with men from the rabble, who put bracelets on your wrists and beautiful crowns on your head. [43] Then I said of her who had grown old in

adulteries: 'Now let them use her as a prostitute, for that is all she is!' [44] And they slept with her as with a prostitute; they slept with Oholah and Oholibah, those lewd women. [45] But righteous men will sentence them to the punishment of those who commit adultery and bloodshed, because they are adulteresses with blood on their hands. [46] This is what the Lord GOD says: 'Bring a mob against them and consign them to terror and plunder.' [47] The mob will stone them and cut them down with their swords. They will kill their sons and daughters and burn down their houses. [48] So I will put an end to indecency in the land, and all the women will be admonished not to imitate your behavior. [49] "They will repay you for your indecency, and you will bear the consequences of your sins of idolatry. Then you will know that I am the Lord GOD.'"

24 In the ninth year, on the tenth day of the tenth month, the word of the LORD came to me, saying, [2] "Son of man, write down today's date, for on this very day the king of Babylon has laid siege to Jerusalem." [3] Now speak a parable to this rebellious house and tell them that this is what the Lord GOD says: 'Put the pot on the fire; put it on and pour in the water.' [4] Put in the pieces of meat, every good piece— thigh and shoulder— fill it with choice bones. [5] Take the choicest of the flock and pile the fuel beneath it. Bring it to a boil and cook the bones in it.' [6] Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: 'Woe to the city of bloodshed, to the pot now rusted, whose rust will not come off! Empty it piece by piece; cast no lots for its contents.' [7] For the blood she shed is still within her; she poured it out on the bare rock; she did not pour it on the ground to cover it with dust. [8] In order to stir up wrath and take vengeance, I have placed her blood on the bare rock, so that it would not be covered.'

[9] Yes, this is what the Lord GOD says: 'Woe to the city of bloodshed! I, too, will pile the kindling high.' [10] Pile on the logs and kindle the fire; cook the meat well and mix in the spices; let the bones be burned. [11] Set the empty pot on its coals until it becomes hot and its copper glows. Then its impurity will melt within; its rust will be consumed.

[12] It has frustrated every effort; its thick rust has not been removed, even by the fire. [13] Because of the indecency of your uncleanness I tried to cleanse you, but you would not be purified from your filthiness. You will not be pure again until My wrath against you has subsided. [14] "I, the LORD, have spoken; the time is coming, and I will act. I will not refrain or show pity, nor will I relent. I will judge you according to your ways and deeds,' declares the Lord GOD." [15] Then the word of the LORD came to me, saying, [16] "Son of man, behold, I am about to take away the desire of your eyes with a fatal blow. But you must not mourn or weep or let your tears flow." [17] "Groan quietly; do not mourn for the dead. Put on your turban and strap your sandals on your feet; do not cover your lips or eat the bread of mourners."

[18] So I spoke to the people in the morning, and in the evening my wife died. And the next morning I did as I had been commanded. [19] Then the people asked me, "Won't you tell us what these things you are doing mean to us?" [20] So I answered them, "The word of the LORD came to me, saying:" [21] Tell the house of Israel that this is what the Lord GOD says: 'I am about to desecrate My sanctuary, the pride of your power, the desire of your eyes, and the delight of your soul. And the sons and daughters you left behind will fall by the sword.' [22] Then you will do as I have done: You will not cover your lips or eat the bread of mourners. [23] Your turbans will remain on your heads and your sandals on your feet. You will not mourn or weep, but you will waste away because of your sins, and you will groan among yourselves. [24] 'Thus Ezekiel will be a sign for you; you will do everything that he has done. When this happens, you will know that I am the Lord GOD.' [25] And you, son of man, know that on the day I take away their stronghold, their pride and joy—the desire of their eyes which uplifted their souls—and their sons and daughters as well, [26] on that day a fugitive will come and tell you the news. [27] "On that day your mouth will be opened to him who has escaped; you will speak and no longer be mute. So you will be a sign to them, and they will know that I am the LORD."

25 Then the word of the LORD came to me, saying, [2] "Son of man, set your face against the Ammonites and prophesy against them." [3] Tell the Ammonites to hear the word of the Lord GOD, for this is what the Lord GOD says: 'Because you exclaimed, "Aha!" when My sanctuary was profaned, when the land of Israel was laid waste, and when the house of Judah went into exile,' [4] therefore I will indeed give you as a possession to the people of the East. They will set up their camps and pitch their tents among you. They will eat your fruit and drink your milk. [5] I will make Rabbah a pasture for camels, and Ammon a resting place for sheep. Then you will know that I am the LORD.' [6] For this is what the Lord GOD says: 'Because you clapped your hands and stomped your feet and rejoiced over the land of Israel with a heart full of contempt,' [7] therefore I will indeed stretch out My hand against you and give you as plunder to the nations. I will cut you off from the peoples and exterminate you from the countries. I will destroy you, and you will know that I am the LORD.'

[8] This is what the Lord GOD says: 'Because Moab and Seir said, "Look, the house of Judah is like all the other nations,"' [9] therefore I will indeed expose the flank of Moab beginning with its frontier cities—Beth-jeshimoth, Baal-meon, and Kiriathaim—the glory of the land. [10] I will give it along with the Ammonites as a possession to the people of the East, so that the Ammonites will no longer be remembered among the nations. [11] So I will execute judgments on Moab, and they will know that I am the LORD.' [12] This is what the Lord GOD says: 'Because Edom acted vengefully against the house of Judah, and in so doing incurred grievous guilt,' [13] therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: I will stretch out My hand against Edom and cut off from it both man and beast. I will make it a wasteland, and from Teman to Dedan they will fall by the sword. [14] I will take My vengeance on Edom by the hand of My people Israel, and they will deal with Edom according to My anger and wrath. Then they will know My vengeance, declares the Lord GOD.' [15] This is what the Lord GOD says: 'Because the Philistines acted in vengeance, taking vengeance with malice of soul to destroy Judah with ancient hostility,' [16] therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: Behold, I will stretch out My hand against the Philistines, and I will cut off the Cherethites and destroy the remnant along the coast. [17] "I will execute great vengeance against them with furious reproof. Then they will know that I am the LORD, when I lay My vengeance upon them.'"

26 In the eleventh month of the twelfth year, on the first day of the month, the word of the LORD came to me, saying, [2] "Son of man, because Tyre has said of Jerusalem, 'Aha! The gate to the nations is broken; it has swung open to me; now that she lies in ruins I will be filled,'" [3] therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: 'Behold, O Tyre, I am against you, and I will raise up many nations against you, as the sea brings up its waves.' [4] They will destroy the walls of Tyre and demolish her towers. I will scrape the soil from her and make her a bare rock. [5] She will become a place to spread nets in the sea, for I have spoken, declares the Lord GOD. She will become plunder for the nations, [6] and the villages on her mainland will be slain by the sword. Then they will know that I am the LORD.'

[7] For this is what the Lord GOD says: 'Behold, I will bring against Tyre from the north Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, king of kings, with horses and chariots, with cavalry and a great company of troops.' [8] He will slaughter the villages of your mainland with the sword; he will set up siege works against you, build a ramp to your walls, and raise his shields against you. [9] He will direct the blows of his battering rams against your walls and tear down your towers with his axes. [10] His multitude of horses will cover you in their dust. When he enters your gates as an army entering a breached city, your walls will shake from the noise of cavalry, wagons, and chariots. [11] The hooves of his horses will trample all your streets. He will slaughter your people with the sword, and your mighty pillars will fall to the ground. [12] They will plunder your wealth and pillage your merchandise. They will demolish your walls, tear down your beautiful homes, and throw your stones and timber and soil into the water. [13] So I will silence the sound of your songs, and the music of your lyres will no longer be heard.

[14] I will make you a bare rock, and you will become a place to spread the fishing nets. You will never be rebuilt, for I, the LORD, have spoken, declares the Lord GOD.'

[15] This is what the Lord GOD says to Tyre: 'Will not the coastlands quake at the sound of your downfall, when the wounded groan at the slaughter in your midst?' [16] All the princes of the sea will descend from their thrones, remove their robes, and strip off their embroidered garments. Clothed with terror, they will sit on the ground, trembling every moment, appalled over you. [17] Then they will lament for you, saying, "How you have perished, O city of renown inhabited by seafaring men — she who was powerful on the sea, along with her people, who imposed terror on all peoples!" [18] "Now the coastlands tremble on the day of your downfall; the islands in the sea are dismayed by your demise."' [19] For this is what the Lord GOD says: 'When I make you a desolate city like other deserted cities, and when I raise up the deep against you so that the mighty waters cover you,' [20] then I will bring you down with those who descend to the Pit, to the people of antiquity. I will make you dwell in the earth below like the ancient ruins, with those who descend to the Pit, so that you will no longer be inhabited or set in splendor in the land of the living. [21] "I will make you an object of horror, and you will be no more. You will be sought, but will never be found,' declares the Lord GOD."

27 Then the word of the LORD came to me, saying, [2] "Now you, son of man, take up a lament for Tyre." [3] Tell Tyre, who dwells at the gateway to the sea, merchant of the peoples on many coasts, that this is what the Lord GOD says: You have said, O Tyre, 'I am perfect in beauty.' [4] Your borders are in the heart of the seas; your builders perfected your beauty. [5] They constructed all your planking with cypress from Senir. They took a cedar from Lebanon to make a mast for you. [6] Of oaks from Bashan they made your oars; of wood from the coasts of Cyprus they made your deck, inlaid with ivory. [7] Of embroidered fine linen from Egypt they made your sail, which served as your banner. Of blue and purple from the coasts of Elishah they made your awning. [8] The men of Sidon and Arvad were your oarsmen. Your men of skill, O Tyre, were there as your captains. [9] The elders of Gebal were aboard as shipwrights, repairing your leaks. All the ships of the sea and their sailors came alongside to barter for your merchandise. [10] Men of Persia, Lydia, and Put served as warriors in your army. They hung their shields and helmets on your walls; they gave you splendor. [11] Men of Arvad and Helech manned your walls all around, and the men of Gammad were in your towers. They hung their shields around your walls; they perfected your beauty.

12 Tarshish was your merchant because of your great wealth of goods; they
exchanged silver, iron, tin, and lead for your wares. 13 Javan, Tubal, and
Meshech were your merchants. They exchanged slaves and bronze utensils for
your merchandise. 14 The men of Beth-togarmah exchanged horses, war horses, and
mules for your wares. 15 The men of Dedan were your clients; many coastlands were
your market; they paid you with ivory tusks and ebony.

16 Aram was your customer because of your many products; they exchanged
turquoise, purple, embroidered work, fine linen, coral, and rubies for your wares.
17 Judah and the land of Israel traded with you; they exchanged wheat from
Minnith, cakes and honey, oil and balm for your merchandise. 18 Because of
your many products and your great wealth of goods, Damascus traded with you
wine from Helbon, wool from Zahar, 19 and casks of wine from Izal for your
wares. Wrought iron, cassia, and sweet cane were exchanged for your merchandise.
20 Dedan was your merchant in saddlecloths for riding. 21 Arabia and all the princes
of Kedar were your customers, trading in lambs, rams, and goats. 22 The merchants
of Sheba and Raamah traded with you; for your wares they exchanged gold, the
finest of all spices, and precious stones. 23 Haran, Canneh, and Eden traded with
you, and so did the merchants of Sheba, Asshur, and Chilmad.

24 In your marketplace they traded with you fine garments of blue, embroidered
work, and multicolored rugs with cords tightly twisted and knotted. 25 The ships
of Tarshish carried your merchandise. And you were filled with heavy cargo in the
heart of the sea. 26 Your oarsmen have brought you onto the high seas, but the east
wind will shatter you in the heart of the sea. 27 Your wealth, wares, and merchandise,
your sailors, captains, and shipwrights, your merchants and all the warriors within
you, with all the other people on board, will sink into the heart of the sea on the
day of your downfall. 28 The countryside will shake when your sailors cry out. 29 All
who handle the oars will abandon their ships. The sailors and all the captains of the
sea will stand on the shore. 30 They will raise their voices for you and cry out bitterly.
They will throw dust on their heads and roll in ashes. 31 They will shave their heads
for you and wrap themselves in sackcloth. They will weep over you with anguish of
soul and bitter mourning. 32 As they wail and mourn over you, they will take up a
lament for you: 'Who was ever like Tyre, silenced in the middle of the sea?' 33 When
your wares went out to sea, you satisfied many nations. You enriched the kings of
the earth with your abundant wealth and merchandise. 34 Now you are shattered by
the seas in the depths of the waters; your merchandise and the people among you
have gone down with you. 35 All the people of the coastlands are appalled over you.
Their kings shudder with fear; their faces are contorted. 36 "Those who trade among
the nations hiss at you; you have come to a horrible end and will be no more.'"

28 And the word of the LORD came to me, saying, 2 "Son of man, tell the ruler
of Tyre that this is what the Lord GOD says: Your heart is proud, and you have said,
'I am a god; I sit in the seat of gods in the heart of the sea.' Yet you are a man and not
a god, though you have regarded your heart as that of a god." 3 Behold, you are wiser
than Daniel; no secret is hidden from you! 4 By your wisdom and understanding
you have gained your wealth and amassed gold and silver for your treasuries. 5 By
your great skill in trading you have increased your wealth, but your heart has grown
proud because of it. 6 Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: Because you regard
your heart as the heart of a god, 7 behold, I will bring foreigners against you, the
most ruthless of nations. They will draw their swords against the beauty of your
wisdom and will defile your splendor.

8 They will bring you down to the Pit, and you will die a violent death in the
heart of the seas. 9 Will you still say, 'I am a god,' in the presence of those who slay
you? You will be only a man, not a god, in the hands of those who wound you.
10 "You will die the death of the uncircumcised at the hands of foreigners. For I
have spoken, declares the Lord GOD." 11 Again the word of the LORD came to
me, saying, 12 "Son of man, take up a lament for the king of Tyre and tell him that
this is what the Lord GOD says: 'You were the seal of perfection, full of wisdom
and perfect in beauty.'"

13 You were in Eden, the garden of God. Every kind of precious stone adorned
you: ruby, topaz, and diamond, beryl, onyx, and jasper, sapphire, turquoise, and
emerald. Your mountings and settings were crafted in gold, prepared on the day of
your creation. 14 You were anointed as a guardian cherub, for I had ordained you.
You were on the holy mountain of God; you walked among the fiery stones. 15 From
the day you were created you were blameless in your ways— until wickedness was
found in you. 16 By the vastness of your trade, you were filled with violence, and you
sinned. So I drove you in disgrace from the mountain of God, and I banished you,
O guardian cherub, from among the fiery stones.

17 Your heart grew proud of your beauty; you corrupted your wisdom because of
your splendor; so I cast you to the earth; I made you a spectacle before kings.
18 By the multitude of your iniquities and the dishonesty of your trading you have
profaned your sanctuaries. So I made fire come from within you, and it consumed
you. I reduced you to ashes on the ground in the eyes of all who saw you. 19 "All the
nations who know you are appalled over you. You have come to a horrible end and
will be no more.'" 20 Then the word of the LORD came to me, saying, 21 "Son of
man, set your face against Sidon and prophesy against her." 22 And you are to declare
that this is what the Lord GOD says: 'Behold, I am against you, O Sidon, and I
will be glorified within you. They will know that I am the LORD when I execute
judgments against her and demonstrate My holiness through her.' 23 I will send a
plague against her and shed blood in her streets; the slain will fall within her, while
the sword is against her on every side. Then they will know that I am the LORD.
24 For the people of Israel will no longer face a pricking brier or a painful thorn from
all around them who treat them with contempt. Then they will know that I am the
Lord GOD.' 25 This is what the Lord GOD says: 'When I gather the house of Israel
from the peoples among whom they have been scattered, I will show Myself holy
among them in the sight of the nations. Then they will dwell in their own land,
which I have given to My servant Jacob.' 26 "And there they will dwell securely, build
houses, and plant vineyards. They will dwell securely when I execute judgments
against all those around them who treat them with contempt. Then they will know
that I am the LORD their God.'"

29 In the tenth year, on the twelfth day of the tenth month, the word of the
LORD came to me, saying, 2 "Son of man, set your face against Pharaoh king of
Egypt and prophesy against him and against all Egypt." 3 Speak to him and tell him
that this is what the Lord GOD says: Behold, I am against you, O Pharaoh king of
Egypt, O great monster who lies among his rivers, who says, 'The Nile is mine; I
made it myself.' 4 But I will put hooks in your jaws and cause the fish of your streams
to cling to your scales. I will haul you up out of your rivers, and all the fish of your
streams will cling to your scales. 5 I will leave you in the desert, you and all the fish of
your streams. You will fall on the open field and will not be taken away or gathered
for burial. I have given you as food to the beasts of the earth and the birds of the air.
6 Then all the people of Egypt will know that I am the LORD. For you were only a
staff of reeds to the house of Israel.

7 When Israel took hold of you with their hands, you splintered, tearing all their
shoulders; when they leaned on you, you broke, and their backs were wrenched.
8 Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: I will bring a sword against you and cut
off from you man and beast. 9 The land of Egypt will become a desolate wasteland.
Then they will know that I am the LORD. Because you said, 'The Nile is mine;
I made it,' 10 therefore I am against you and against your rivers. I will turn the
land of Egypt into a ruin, a desolate wasteland from Migdol to Syene, and as far
as the border of Cush. 11 No foot of man or beast will pass through, and it will be
uninhabited for forty years. 12 I will make the land of Egypt a desolation among
desolate lands, and her cities will lie desolate for forty years among the ruined cities.
And I will disperse the Egyptians among the nations and scatter them throughout
the countries. 13 For this is what the Lord GOD says: At the end of forty years I will
gather the Egyptians from the nations to which they were scattered.

14 I will restore Egypt from captivity and bring them back to the land of Pathros, the
land of their origin. There they will be a lowly kingdom. 15 Egypt will be the lowliest
of kingdoms and will never again exalt itself above the nations. For I will diminish
Egypt so that it will never again rule over the nations. 16 "Egypt will never again be
an object of trust for the house of Israel, but will remind them of their iniquity in
turning to the Egyptians. Then they will know that I am the Lord GOD." 17 In the
twenty-seventh year, on the first day of the first month, the word of the LORD
came to me, saying, 18 "Son of man, Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon caused
his army to labor strenuously against Tyre. Every head was made bald and every
shoulder made raw. But he and his army received no wages from Tyre for the labor
they expended on it." 19 Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: I will give the
land of Egypt to Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, who will carry off its wealth,
seize its spoil, and remove its plunder. This will be the wages for his army. 20 I have
given him the land of Egypt as the reward for his labor, because it was done for Me,
declares the Lord GOD. 21 "In that day I will cause a horn to sprout for the house
of Israel, and I will open your mouth to speak among them. Then they will know
that I am the LORD."

30 Again the word of the LORD came to me, saying, 2 "Son of man, prophesy
and declare that this is what the Lord GOD says: Wail, 'Alas for that day!'" 3 For
the day is near, the Day of the LORD is near. It will be a day of clouds, a time of
doom for the nations. 4 A sword will come against Egypt, and there will be anguish
in Cush when the slain fall in Egypt, its wealth is taken away, and its foundations
are torn down. 5 Cush, Put, and Lud, and all the various peoples, as well as Libya
and the men of the covenant land, will fall with Egypt by the sword. 6 For this
is what the LORD says: The allies of Egypt will fall, and her proud strength will
collapse. From Migdol to Syene they will fall by the sword within her, declares the
Lord GOD. 7 They will be desolate among desolate lands, and their cities will lie
among ruined cities.

8 Then they will know that I am the LORD when I set fire to Egypt and all her
helpers are shattered. 9 On that day messengers will go out from Me in ships to
frighten Cush out of complacency. Anguish will come upon them on the day of
Egypt's doom. For it is indeed coming. 10 This is what the Lord GOD says: I will
put an end to the hordes of Egypt by the hand of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon.
11 He and his people with him, the most ruthless of the nations, will be brought in
to destroy the land. They will draw their swords against Egypt and fill the land with
the slain. 12 I will make the streams dry up and sell the land to the wicked. By the

hands of foreigners I will bring desolation upon the land and everything in it. I, the LORD, have spoken.

13 This is what the Lord GOD says: I will destroy the idols and put an end to
the images in Memphis. There will no longer be a prince in Egypt, and I will instill
fear in that land. 14 I will lay waste Pathros, set fire to Zoan, and execute judgment
on Thebes. 15 I will pour out My wrath on Pelusium, the stronghold of Egypt, and
cut off the crowds of Thebes. 16 I will set fire to Egypt, Pelusium will writhe in
anguish, Thebes will be split open, and Memphis will face daily distress.

17 The young men of On and Pi-beseth will fall by the sword, and those cities will
go into captivity. 18 The day will be darkened in Tahpanhes when I break the yoke
of Egypt and her proud strength comes to an end. A cloud will cover her, and
her daughters will go into captivity. 19 "So I will execute judgment on Egypt, and
they will know that I am the LORD." 20 In the eleventh year, on the seventh day
of the first month, the word of the LORD came to me, saying, 21 "Son of man,
I have broken the arm of Pharaoh king of Egypt. See, it has not been bound up
for healing, or splinted for strength to hold the sword." 22 Therefore this is what
the Lord GOD says: Behold, I am against Pharaoh king of Egypt. I will break his
arms, both the strong one and the one already broken, and will make the sword
fall from his hand. 23 I will disperse the Egyptians among the nations and scatter
them throughout the lands. 24 I will strengthen the arms of Babylon's king and
place My sword in his hand, but I will break the arms of Pharaoh, who will groan
before him like a mortally wounded man. 25 I will strengthen the arms of Babylon's
king, but Pharaoh's arms will fall limp. Then they will know that I am the LORD,
when I place My sword in the hand of Babylon's king, and he wields it against the
land of Egypt. 26 "I will disperse the Egyptians among the nations and scatter them
throughout the lands. Then they will know that I am the LORD."

31 In the eleventh year, on the first day of the third month, the word of the
LORD came to me, saying, 2 "Son of man, say to Pharaoh king of Egypt and to his
multitude: 'Who can be compared to your greatness?'" 3 Look at Assyria, a cedar
in Lebanon, with beautiful branches that shaded the forest. It towered on high;
its top was among the clouds. 4 The waters made it grow; the deep springs made
it tall, directing their streams all around its base and sending their channels to all
the trees of the field. 5 Therefore it towered higher than all the trees of the field. Its
branches multiplied, and its boughs grew long as it spread them out because of the
abundant waters. 6 All the birds of the air nested in its branches, and all the beasts
of the field gave birth beneath its boughs; all the great nations lived in its shade. 7 It
was beautiful in its greatness, in the length of its limbs, for its roots extended to
abundant waters. 8 The cedars in the garden of God could not rival it; the cypresses
could not compare with its branches, nor the plane trees match its boughs. No tree
in the garden of God could compare with its beauty.

9 I made it beautiful with its many branches, the envy of all the trees of Eden,
which were in the garden of God.' 10 Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says:
'Since it became great in height and set its top among the clouds, and it grew proud
on account of its height,' 11 I delivered it into the hand of the ruler of the nations,
for him to deal with it according to its wickedness. I have banished it. 12 Foreigners,
the most ruthless of the nations, cut it down and left it. Its branches have fallen on
the mountains and in every valley; its boughs lay broken in all the earth's ravines.
And all the peoples of the earth left its shade and abandoned it. 13 All the birds of the
air nested on its fallen trunk, and all the beasts of the field lived among its boughs.
14 This happened so that no other trees by the waters would become great in height
and set their tops among the clouds, and no other well-watered trees would reach
them in height. For they have all been consigned to death, to the depths of the
earth, among the mortals who descend to the Pit.' 15 This is what the Lord GOD
says: 'On the day it was brought down to Sheol, I caused mourning. I covered the
deep because of it; I held back its rivers; its abundant waters were restrained. I made
Lebanon mourn for it, and all the trees of the field fainted because of it.' 16 I made
the nations quake at the sound of its downfall, when I cast it down to Sheol with
those who descend to the Pit. Then all the trees of Eden, the choicest and best of
Lebanon, all the well-watered trees, were consoled in the earth below. 17 They too
descended with it to Sheol, to those slain by the sword. As its allies they had lived in
its shade among the nations. 18 "Who then is like you in glory and greatness among
the trees of Eden? You also will be brought down to the depths of the earth to be
with the trees of Eden. You will lie among the uncircumcised, with those slain by
the sword. This is Pharaoh and all his multitude, declares the Lord GOD.'"

32 In the twelfth year, on the first day of the twelfth month, the word of the
LORD came to me, saying, 2 "Son of man, take up a lament for Pharaoh king of
Egypt and say to him: 'You are like a lion among the nations; you are like a monster
in the seas. You thrash about in your rivers, churning up the waters with your feet
and muddying the streams.'" 3 This is what the Lord GOD says: 'I will spread
My net over you with a company of many peoples, and they will draw you up in
My net.' 4 I will abandon you on the land and hurl you into the open field. I will
cause all the birds of the air to settle upon you, and all the beasts of the earth to
eat their fill of you. 5 I will put your flesh on the mountains and fill the valleys with
your remains. 6 I will drench the land with the flow of your blood, all the way to
the mountains— the ravines will be filled. 7 When I extinguish you, I will cover the
heavens and darken their stars. I will cover the sun with a cloud, and the moon will
not give its light. 8 All the shining lights in the heavens I will darken over you, and
I will bring darkness upon your land,' declares the Lord GOD. 9 'I will trouble the
hearts of many peoples, when I bring about your destruction among the nations,
in countries you do not know.'

10 I will cause many peoples to be appalled over you, and their kings will shudder
in horror because of you when I brandish My sword before them. On the day of
your downfall each of them will tremble every moment for his life.' 11 For this is
what the Lord GOD says: 'The sword of the king of Babylon will come against you!'
12 I will make your hordes fall by the swords of the mighty, the most ruthless of all
nations. They will ravage the pride of Egypt and all her multitudes will be destroyed.
13 I will slaughter all her cattle beside the abundant waters. No human foot will
muddy them again, and no cattle hooves will disturb them.

14 Then I will let her waters settle and will make her rivers flow like oil,' declares
the Lord GOD. 15 'When I make the land of Egypt a desolation and empty it of
all that filled it, when I strike down all who live there, then they will know that I
am the LORD.' 16 "This is the lament they will chant for her; the daughters of the
nations will chant it. Over Egypt and all her multitudes they will chant it, declares
the Lord GOD." 17 In the twelfth year, on the fifteenth day of the month, the
word of the LORD came to me, saying, 18 "Son of man, wail for the multitudes of
Egypt, and consign her and the daughters of the mighty nations to the depths of
the earth with those who descend to the Pit:" 19 Whom do you surpass in beauty?
Go down and be placed with the uncircumcised! 20 They will fall among those
slain by the sword. The sword is appointed! Let them drag her away along with
all her multitudes.

21 Mighty chiefs will speak from the midst of Sheol about Egypt and her allies: 'They
have come down and lie with the uncircumcised, with those slain by the sword.'
22 Assyria is there with her whole company; her graves are all around her. All of
them are slain, fallen by the sword. 23 Her graves are set in the depths of the Pit,
and her company is all around her grave. All of them are slain, fallen by the sword
— those who once spread terror in the land of the living. 24 Elam is there with all
her multitudes around her grave. All of them are slain, fallen by the sword— those
who went down uncircumcised to the earth below, who once spread their terror in
the land of the living. They bear their disgrace with those who descend to the Pit.
25 Among the slain they prepare a resting place for Elam with all her hordes, with her
graves all around her. All of them are uncircumcised, slain by the sword, although
their terror was once spread in the land of the living. They bear their disgrace with
those who descend to the Pit. They are placed among the slain. 26 Meshech and
Tubal are there with all their multitudes, with their graves all around them. All of
them are uncircumcised, slain by the sword, because they spread their terror in the
land of the living. 27 They do not lie down with the fallen warriors of old, who went
down to Sheol with their weapons of war, whose swords were placed under their
heads, whose shields rested on their bones, although the terror of the mighty was
once in the land of the living. 28 But you too will be shattered and lie down among
the uncircumcised, with those slain by the sword. 29 Edom is there, and all her kings
and princes, who despite their might are laid among those slain by the sword. They
lie down with the uncircumcised, with those who descend to the Pit. 30 All the
leaders of the north and all the Sidonians are there; they went down in disgrace with
the slain, despite the terror of their might. They lie uncircumcised with those slain
by the sword and bear their shame with those who descend to the Pit. 31 Pharaoh
will see them and be comforted over all his multitude— Pharaoh and all his army,
slain by the sword, declares the Lord GOD. 32 "For I will spread My terror in the
land of the living, so that Pharaoh and all his multitude will be laid to rest among
the uncircumcised, with those slain by the sword, declares the Lord GOD."

33 Again the word of the LORD came to me, saying, 2 "Son of man, speak to
your people and tell them: 'Suppose I bring the sword against a land, and the people
of that land choose a man from among them, appointing him as their watchman,'"
3 and he sees the sword coming against that land and blows the ram's horn to
warn the people. 4 Then if anyone hears the sound of the horn but fails to heed
the warning, and the sword comes and takes him away, his blood will be on his
own head. 5 Since he heard the sound of the horn but failed to heed the warning, his
blood will be on his own head. If he had heeded the warning, he would have saved
his life. 6 But if the watchman sees the sword coming and fails to blow the horn to
warn the people, and the sword comes and takes away a life, then that one will be
taken away in his iniquity, but I will hold the watchman accountable for his blood.'
7 As for you, O son of man, I have made you a watchman for the house of Israel;
so hear the word from My mouth and give them the warning from Me. 8 If I say
to the wicked, 'O wicked man, you will surely die,' but you do not speak out to
dissuade him from his way, then that wicked man will die in his iniquity, yet I will
hold you accountable for his blood. 9 But if you warn the wicked man to turn from
his way, and he does not turn from it, he will die in his iniquity, but you will have
saved your life. 10 Now as for you, son of man, tell the house of Israel that this is
what they have said: 'Our transgressions and our sins are heavy upon us, and we are
wasting away because of them! How can we live?'

[11] Say to them: 'As surely as I live, declares the Lord GOD, I take no pleasure in
the death of the wicked, but rather that the wicked should turn from their ways and
live. Turn! Turn from your evil ways! For why should you die, O house of Israel?'
[12] Therefore, son of man, say to your people: 'The righteousness of the righteous
man will not deliver him in the day of his transgression; neither will the wickedness
of the wicked man cause him to stumble on the day he turns from his wickedness.
Nor will the righteous man be able to survive by his righteousness on the day
he sins.' [13] If I tell the righteous man that he will surely live, but he then trusts in
his righteousness and commits iniquity, then none of his righteous works will be
remembered; he will die because of the iniquity he has committed. [14] But if I tell the
wicked man, 'You will surely die,' and he turns from his sin and does what is just
and right— [15] if he restores a pledge, makes restitution for what he has stolen, and
walks in the statutes of life without practicing iniquity—then he will surely live; he
will not die.

[16] None of the sins he has committed will be held against him. He has done what
is just and right; he will surely live. [17] Yet your people say, 'The way of the Lord is
not just.' But it is their way that is not just. [18] If a righteous man turns from his
righteousness and commits iniquity, he will die for it. [19] But if a wicked man turns
from his wickedness and does what is just and right, he will live because of this.
[20] "Yet you say, 'The way of the Lord is not just.' But I will judge each of you
according to his ways, O house of Israel." [21] In the twelfth year of our exile, on the
fifth day of the tenth month, a fugitive from Jerusalem came to me and reported,
"The city has been taken!"

[22] Now the evening before the fugitive arrived, the hand of the LORD was upon
me, and He opened my mouth before the man came to me in the morning. So my
mouth was opened and I was no longer mute. [23] Then the word of the LORD came
to me, saying, [24] "Son of man, those living in the ruins in the land of Israel are saying,
'Abraham was only one man, yet he possessed the land. But we are many; surely
the land has been given to us as a possession.'" [25] Therefore tell them that this is
what the Lord GOD says: 'You eat meat with the blood in it, lift up your eyes to
your idols, and shed blood. Should you then possess the land?' [26] You have relied on
your swords, you have committed detestable acts, and each of you has defiled his
neighbor's wife. Should you then possess the land?' [27] Tell them that this is what
the Lord GOD says: 'As surely as I live, those in the ruins will fall by the sword,
those in the open field I will give to be devoured by wild animals, and those in the
strongholds and caves will die by plague.' [28] I will make the land a desolate waste, and
the pride of her strength will come to an end. The mountains of Israel will become
desolate, so that no one will pass through. [29] Then they will know that I am the
LORD, when I have made the land a desolate waste because of all the abominations
they have committed.' [30] As for you, son of man, your people are talking about you
near the city walls and in the doorways of their houses. One speaks to another, each
saying to his brother, 'Come and hear the message that has come from the LORD!'
[31] So My people come to you as usual, sit before you, and hear your words; but they
do not put them into practice. Although they express love with their mouths, their
hearts pursue dishonest gain. [32] Indeed, you are to them like a singer of love songs
with a beautiful voice, who skillfully plays an instrument. They hear your words
but do not put them into practice.